

The Office of Helps

The devil knows how to handle a real zealous fellow. Nobody is calling most people's zeal into question, especially fasting and praying people. It is just that the devil knows if he can get you off one degree, he can get you to beating the air.

Your zeal is not in question. He just has to lead you into spending your life in what is not producing.

When God gave me the worship limb, I went out under the power that day and He said, "You do not know much about worship."

I had been on a certain day of a fast, so I started protesting. I said, "What about fasting?"

He said, "Fasting cannot give you what worship does. Neither can worship give you what fasting does."

Then old pastors went through me, men I knew who fasted two forty-day fasts a year, yet they were nowhere near the greatest ministries I had ever seen.

He said, "So it is when a man puts all his faith in one key." There were other areas of their lives, He told me, that He could not get to.

I said, "If I were guilty, God, I would be guilty of holding the key of praying in tongues above every other key."

That is when He said to me, "Son, what is the first gifting you receive from Me upon your baptism?"

I know my own teachings. The moment I am filled with the Holy Ghost, I fulfill the eighth operation of God listed in the chapter we are turning to: diversities of tongues.

Can you fulfill apostle, prophet, teacher, pastor, evangelist, helps, and governments simultaneously with your rebirth? You may put yourself in those offices, but generally you will not fulfill them supernaturally at that moment.

Which one do I fulfill supernaturally the same second I receive the new birth flooding my spirit? What gift can I operate in supernaturally, one that does not originate with me, instantaneous with my rebirth, like at Cornelius' house? Tongues.

Fortunately, He told me I chose the one key that would not have made me lopsided. Praying in tongues is a revelation key. It caused the birth of the born-again trail in me, and all the other limbs are supported by it.

So I got into worship, and He used the advantage of His presence on me for those hours to start illuminating difficult, dark areas I would not want to take into the great judgment seat of Christ's room. I would rather face His presence now and be rewarded then.

He started showing me where I was a degree off.

I understood what He was saying, because if my zeal is off into legalism, I end up like a monk in a cave somewhere trying to get God to do something that can only be done by grace.

It is all right to be legalistic, if you want to say it that way, about praying in tongues and worship, because those things will produce grace. But there are certain things you cannot be legalistic over.

I am prone to condemn myself from time to time, because the estimation I have of myself always falls short of where I should be. Nevertheless, if I am off a degree in legalism and grace, He is teaching me the things I need to give myself to that produce the grace which produces His standing, not mine.

The more I worship Him, the more I am finding out that God is treating me as though I am already supposed to be where those programs were done.

One of my degrees of legalism was attacked severely when I went over to Brazil, when I was dying to the love of money.

I would not receive offerings in Brazil. I would not hand out envelopes for this building. I just stood there and blatantly believed God.

Then Dinar began and said, "I know he does not want anything from Brazil. I know that. But I am going to do this." He proceeded to receive an offering for me.

I started to get up and stop him. I started to say, "Oh no, no," and the Lord rebuked me. It was horrible.

I will give you my interpretation of what He said:

"Why do you not just sit back down and be quiet? Why do you not get rid of some of that false humility? You are a degree off. What do you want to do, stand out there and say, 'Oh no, no,' so they will worship you? What do you want, boy?"

He said, "If you really wanted something other than what they were giving you, you would receive the offering and then go give it to some need privately without anybody knowing. Wouldn't you, boy?"

So let us talk about works versus grace in a very dangerous area.

Follow closely. Pay attention. God is treating me like I know something, like I am supposed to be somewhere. I am going to treat you the same.

Turnabout is fair play.

Begin with 1 Corinthians 12:1:

Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.

Ye know that ye were Gentiles, carried away unto these dumb idols, even as ye were led.

In other words, those idols could not speak, and you were led by devils. But now that you serve the living God, He speaks. He is not like those dumb idols.

Paul continues:

Wherefore I give you to understand, that no man speaking by the Spirit of God calleth Jesus accursed: and that no man can say that Jesus is the Lord, but by the Holy Ghost.

The way men call Jesus accursed is by saying He did not go to the cross for your sins.

Then Paul says:

Now there are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit.

And there are differences of administrations, but the same Lord.

And there are diversities of operations, but it is the same God which worketh all in all.

The Holy Spirit operates the diversities of gifts. Jesus separates you to your callings, your administrations: apostle, prophet, and so on. There are diversities of operations. An operation of God, like an apostle, is a combination of the nine gifts in the calling. It is the same God who works all the gifts and all the callings.

When Paul said he did not want you ignorant concerning spiritual gifts, he was not just talking about the nine gifts of the Spirit. That is all we have preached out of that chapter. He also did not want you ignorant of the callings or operations of God Jesus separated you to.

Every one of you is called to one or more of these callings. Paul lists them beginning with verse 27:

Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.

And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.

He lists first apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then miracles, gifts of healings, helps, governments, and finally the eighth operation: diversities, or different supernatural manifestations, of that supernatural language of God.

Tongues simply means languages. Sometimes we say, "He spoke in the language of tongues." We are actually saying he spoke in the language of languages. It is like saying, "He spoke in the Hebrew tongue." It is old King James English.

This is saying diversities: different operations of supernatural languages uttered by the Holy Spirit through your spirit, including the one from heaven that you use for your own personal prayer life, the language of edification.

In this lineup of eight operations, notice that Paul lists them as they come into existence in some kind of order of operation and effectiveness.

He placed first apostles, second prophets, third teachers. After that, workings of miracles and gifts of healings, which encompass pastor and evangelist. That means entry level into the fivefold ministry as listed in Ephesians 4:

He ascended on high and gave gifts unto men... apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors and teachers.

In 1 Corinthians 12, Paul left pastor and evangelist out and replaced them with workings of miracles and gifts of healings. The basic information of pastor and evangelist is that one stands and teaches and preaches, and the other moves from place to place and teaches and preaches. But Paul replaced them with miracles and healings, saying entry level into the fivefold should be qualified by those two gifts.

My pastor said if it is not accompanied by those two, then you are a Holy Ghost-filled, glorified exhorter.

"Oh, how I love Jesus."

"Well, I am called to teach."

Teacher is even higher than pastor and evangelist. It is listed above workings of miracles and gifts of healings.

"I am just called to be a teacher."

My God, then not only are you used in miracles, you can explain how you are used. You are a teacher.

"Well, I am just called to teach on it, not operate in it."

You are called to cop out, using language to explain why.

Why did the teacher come into existence in that order? Benny Hinn may have workings of miracles, and it is wonderful. But one called higher, the teacher, fully qualified and mature in his gift, can not only have miracles happen but teach others how to receive and operate in them.

It is one thing to be Benny Hinn and go from city to city in miracles, causing hundreds of thousands to be saved. It is another thing to land in a city and, when you leave, have taught everybody how to receive those miracles themselves, operate in them, and loose those people on the next city. That is the difference.

When you are ready for your first flight and the instructor takes his hands off the yoke of the airplane, there are two yokes: one on the passenger's side and one on the driver's side. If I am teaching you to fly and say, "Okay, you take it," and suddenly I am the passenger, I would start screaming, "Take the yoke! Take the yoke!"

"Man, I do not fly these things. I just teach on them."

"The other pilot parachuted out. See that little white dot going down? That is our death."

When we get to helps and governments, tell me this: the way helps and governments has been taught in church, would you teach on prophet first and then put apostle under him? I do not think so.

Yet helps and governments are listed in such a way that helps comes first and then governments. There is a separation between the two. Why would helps be a priority gift?

The way it was taught to me for twenty years was that government is the smart fellow. He reads the schematics and blueprints. He is an organizer. He understands organization. Helps, after the government guy unfolds the schematic and finds out where to dig the first hole, is the guy with the shovel.

Why are they listed backwards? Did that ever bother anybody else?

When I found out what helps is in effectiveness, and when you clear the fivefold, helps is much more powerful than government.

I did not know where to find what I was hearing in my spirit. I kept listening to my spirit, but what I was hearing did not make much sense. It went against twenty years of pre-programming.

I know it is God's will to bless everyone extremely and for you to bless people in need. I know it is His will to give you as much as your flesh will let you receive. I know that.

But even though it is His will for everyone to testify, it is not His will for everyone to preach. Even though it is His will for all the fivefold to preach or teach, it is not His will for everyone to be an apostle or for everyone to be a prophet. There is a separation that takes place.

Even though I am beginning to understand helps now, I know He wants to bless you just as much as your flesh can stand to be blessed. If you are blessed out of season with your flesh, then your flesh will usually take that money and rule over you like some weakling being dragged along by a ring in your nose to gratify your flesh.

He wants to bless you as much as your current standing can handle. But there is a calling where people are called by God to become a great big funnel, a siphoning hose, to go get the world's money and support the whole gospel with it.

They are the entrepreneurs. They are the James Bonds of finances for the body of Christ. Their minds are pickled in the anointing for one reason: to pay big mouths to get the world saved, and to lay so much treasure up on their account that when they walk into heaven, it will look like John

Wayne's safari trophy room.

They are the entrepreneurs for the kingdom of God.

Which calling is listed right after the fivefold? Helps.

Let me tell you where I found it first. Not in the Greek. I found it first when He whispered in a mystery to me:

"Son, your answer is in Romans 12."

The last time He said anything like that to me was when I was preaching on the stripes and not rightly discerning the Lord's body. He said, "This is My body, which was broken." I found out the stripes were connected to the broken body and healed us from controversy.

When He wanted me to know why people were not healed for not rightly discerning the Lord's body, He wanted me to know the stripes healed them from lack of peace, torment, division, and strife.

He said, "Your answer is under the law." I went back to Deuteronomy 25. If there was a controversy between two men, they went before a righteous judge. The one judged wrong by the righteous judge was laid down and took up to thirty-nine lashes. Isaiah 53 says the chastisement for my lack of peace was upon Him, and with His stripes I was healed.

Jesus went before the righteous Judge, God, because He took my place. He was judged in my place and took the maximum penalty, thirty-nine lashes.

Now He said the same thing about helps: "Son, your answer is in Romans 12."

I found it. Romans 12:1 says:

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

Present your bodies a living sacrifice like Paul taught in Romans 8. Do not be conformed to this world anymore. Be transformed by renewing your mind to find the perfect will of God that He called you to fulfill in the body of Christ.

Verse 3 says:

For I say, through the grace given unto me, to every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly, according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.

Paul speaks through the grace given to him, the grace for his calling. You are called to your office, given the measure of faith for it, and separated to it by the grace of God. You have faith for it.

Measure means part of a whole. You have the measure for your calling. I have the faith for mine. All the measures working together make one whole devil-stomping, mountain-moving body of Christ.

You have the measure for your call. Do not tell me you cannot fulfill it. That is what your reward is based on. When you stand before Him, your reward will be based on what you did with the measure, because He gave you enough faith for your call.

"No, He did not."

Yes, He did. You just did not equip yourself for it. You had the faith for it. He delivered you the measure for your call.

Verse 4 says:

For as we have many members in one body, and all members have not the same office:
So we, being many, are one body in Christ, and every one members one of another.
Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us...

The grace that separated Paul to his apostleship is the same election and choosing of God that separated you to yours. We have gifts differing according to grace, not my choosing. God's grace separated me to my calling and you to yours. I did not choose it. He did.

So he says not to think of yourself more highly than you ought, as if you put yourself in your office. Then He gave you the measure of faith needed to fulfill it.

Verse 6 says:

Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us, whether prophecy, let us prophesy according to the proportion of faith;
Or ministry, let us wait on our ministering: or he that teacheth, on teaching;
Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.

Paul starts listing gifts and callings together, just like in 1 Corinthians 12 and Ephesians 4.

If your gift is differing and you are called to operate in prophecy, prophesy according to the proportion of faith. If your calling is ministry, wait on your ministry. If teaching, wait on teaching.

How do I wait? You do not sit around in a chair and quit your job. You wait on God like a waiter waits on a table. How? That is what the first verses said: present your body a living sacrifice and offer yourself to do the mind of Christ in the power of the Holy Spirit. You will find it all.

Then notice verse 8 closely. Here are the sixth and seventh operations in the body of Christ: helps and governments.

He that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence.

When Paul explains the operation of helps, he substitutes the word giveth. When he explains governments, he substitutes ruleth, through organizational skills.

This is getting good.

I finally went to the Greek. I like some of these helps, though I usually stay away from their explanations. I wish they would just stick to the facts.

One reference said that Paul transfers the discussion from people to gifts. Miracles, healings, and tongues have been discussed earlier. Helps is a ministry not found elsewhere.

Helps is only listed once with no explanation, so they did not know what to do with it. They were forced to stick close to the Greek meaning.

It appears to be those who have compassion and minister to the sick, weak, or helpless in some fashion. Special persons without set offices may render special assistance in needy cases. Helps parallels "he that giveth" in Romans 12:8, and governments parallels "he that ruleth."

As close as they could get, it appears to be people of means who, outside all the other gifts, are able to render assistance in certain cases.

When God handled giving, He handled it differently than prayer and fasting. No wonder: when it comes to money, it carries power that is unparalleled. If there is anything in your flesh that sudden money will let out, it is coming out.

Jesus handled prayer, fasting, and giving in Matthew 6. Let us glean a little from that.

Matthew 6:5 says:

And when thou prayest, thou shalt not be as the hypocrites are: for they love to pray standing in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.

Notice the standard He set. He was dealing with the motives of the heart.

Now look at the standard He set for fasting in verse 16:

Moreover when ye fast, be not, as the hypocrites, of a sad countenance: for they disfigure their faces, that they may appear unto men to fast. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

But thou, when thou fastest, anoint thine head, and wash thy face;

That thou appear not unto men to fast, but unto thy Father which is in secret: and thy Father, which seeth in secret, shall reward thee openly.

I like that He handled fasting just like prayer. He did not say, "When He moves on you to fast." He said, "When."

People say, "He moves on me to pray."

Is that the only time?

The hypocrites disfigure their faces so they may appear to men to fast.

"Are you eating?"

"No."

"Why not?"

"I am just not."

"Is there anything wrong?"

"No, really."

"What is it?"

"I was not going to say anything. Did my sad countenance give me away? I am fasting."

On the first fast I ever went on, thank God He has grace in the ignorance of childhood. I would follow a kid on a tricycle around and say, "Hey, look at me. I have been fasting." I did not even want to forget I was going without eating.

Jesus said that when you fast, anoint your head and wash your face so you do not appear to men to fast, but to your Father in secret. Your Father who sees in secret will reward you openly.

In prayer and fasting, He says to remove yourself from anything and anyone so that all you do is before God and God alone, and He will reward you openly.

But the only one He varied from that standard on was giving. He got harder.

Matthew 6:1 says:

Take heed that ye do not your alms before men, to be seen of them: otherwise ye have no reward of your Father which is in heaven.

Therefore when thou doest thine alms, do not sound a trumpet before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may have glory of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

But when thou doest alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth:

That thine alms may be in secret: and thy Father which seeth in secret himself shall reward thee openly.

There are no ifs or buts about the reward.

In prayer and fasting, He said to remove yourself from other people, close the door, and do it in secret. But when it came to giving, He said, "Do not let your left hand know what your right hand is doing."

It is easy to enter a closet and close the door. I am on one side of the door and you are on the other. Everything I do is in secret. But when it came to giving, He said not to let my left hand know what my right hand is doing.

How do I do that? Separate myself from you into the closet and close the door on my hand?

"Sorry, hand. I have to leave you outside. You cannot know what I am doing."

What kind of deal is this? I can understand shutting myself off from you. How do I shut myself off from myself?

When it comes to money and giving, He is saying you cannot trust even your own flesh.

He did not call the love of money the root of all evil for no reason. He said men who suppose that gain is godliness are destitute of the truth. Godliness with contentment is great gain. You brought nothing into this world, and materialistically you will bring nothing out of it. The next world you come into, it would be nice to have something there. That is the treasure He talks about in the next verses.

How do I do this? I cannot trust my own flesh.

Helps and governments were separated. Why? Because helps is a separate ministry from governments.

It is so undoctrinal and untraditional. If you go more extensively into the Greek, it says this person seems to be a person of means who comes alongside.

He separated helps from governments because when it comes to the flesh, there is much temptation. That is why He said not to let your left hand know what your right hand is doing.

I have been around many wealthy men. They are men of power. When they say something, they expect you to do it. When they approach airports and I would park my plane out there, two accountants could hardly keep up with them, running behind them with ostrich-skin briefcases. This man made them rich. I wanted to stand by the door and open it for him. I probably would have if the accountants had not beaten me to it.

They project that kind of authority. They rule over an entire domain. People come, go, and do what they tell them.

God separated helps from governments because a man with that kind of power would have the tendency to want to rule the government, rule the pastor, and rule the church.

For your own safety, you need not to trust your own flesh. When you let it go, let it go.

It is amazing to me that there is a calling like that.

Jesus said not to let your left hand know what your right hand is doing. You cannot trust your own flesh.

God wants to bless everybody. He will give you as much as He can give you. But these are they who were sown among thorns: the deceitfulness of riches sprang up and choked the Word of God out of them. When the Word in you was destroyed, that was the last time He blessed you.

"But I am blessed."

A man who is controlled by his money is not blessed. He just does not know it.

The deceitfulness of riches enters in, chokes the Word, and it becomes unfruitful. That is the last blessing. Do you think God can pour money out on you to your own spiritual destruction?

The cares of this world, the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things are the three levels of the final takeout.

So when God showed me in worship that I was a degree off in several areas, I started to jump up and say, "Oh no, just take this up and give it to him. Give this to this man."

He said, "Why do you not just be quiet and sit back down? If you are that humble, receive it and give it to somebody without anybody knowing."

Will we ever tell what we know? No, that is not what He was saying. He was talking about the ability of the flesh to control you and want to control everybody else. That is what He wanted to kill.

But I do advise, on any spiritual level, not to discuss your affairs with anyone unless they are on the same level. All they will do is take the information and destroy you.

Have you had a good time?